

—HELEN, \$1.1 MILLION NET WORTH

We started out in 1969 newly married, owning two old suitcases and a \$350 VW Beetle. Now we own two homes and four cars, and we are debt-free. We pay cash for anything we wish, including cars. If we can't afford to pay for it in cash, we don't buy it.

—TOM, \$1.9 MILLION NET WORTH

Growing up in a large family, there wasn't much money. I was mostly independent by the time I was fifteen. I moved out at eighteen, bought myself a beater car, and put myself through college with scholarships and working. Growing up this way was hard, but very beneficial to me.

—STEVEN, \$2.2 MILLION NET WORTH

Save early and consistently. It seems like a pipe dream at the time, but compound interest is real! Just give it time.

—JOHN, \$1.4 MILLION NET WORTH

Hard work is the key. If I want to do something that is not in the budget, I earn the money through a second or third job.

—GLENN, \$3.5 MILLION NET WORTH

I never pay someone for labor. Instead, I turn off the TV and make it a hobby of mine to learn whatever skills are needed to perform house or vehicle maintenance, manage investments, and so on.

—PAUL, \$1.2 MILLION NET WORTH

The absolute secret is to spend less than you make. Live within your means and understand wants versus needs. Be willing to miss out on short-term fulfillment. No debt allows you to live on a lot less!

—DONNA, \$1.1 MILLION NET WORTH

My single mother came to this country with three kids, not knowing the language. She taught us discipline and hard work. I am what I am today because of her and my uncle.

—LOUIS, \$5.5 MILLION NET WORTH

All you really have to do to become wealthy is pay attention. There was a time that we made a lot of money, but we also spent a lot of money. Now we start our budget by giving and saving, and we pay attention to where the money goes.